

GENERAL SEARCH ENGINES



Illustrations: Farzana Cooper

Google

Think search, and chances are you'll think www.google.com. Here's how we make the reliable horse work better for you.

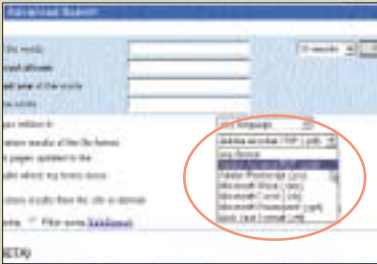
At Google's home page, if you click on Advanced Search, you can access advanced options that narrow down results to more specific links.

Language

You tend to get a lot of non-English results whilst searching. By restricting your search to English sites from the drop-down box, you don't waste time on results you can't understand anyway.

Getting format specific

You can search specifically for, say, PDFs or PPT files. Choose the format of your choice across the six listed on the Advanced page, or exclude the results that



Want more than plain HTML? Look for specific document file types

return formats that you don't want, by selecting the format and clicking 'Don't'.

Here's a word

If you usually look for specific words in a Web page, fine-tune Google to do just that. Use the Occurrences option that lets you specify where you want to see the search terms, whether in the text, URL, title, or anywhere else in the page.

Domaining it

The Domain option lets you limit searches to a particular domain, or avoid bringing up results from it. Fill in the

domain box with a Web site that you want to restrict results to, and select Only, or avoid picking up results from, by selecting Don't from the drop-down box.

Pageing specifically

The options under the Page-Specific Search heading allow for quickly locating pages that offer services, or have content similar to that of a specified Web page. For instance, if you enter 'space.com' (a site for astronomy enthusiasts), the similar pages listed include some from NASA as well as Sky and Telescope magazine, and several other well-known space-enthusiast sites.

Preferences

If Google is your tool of trade, it makes sense to tweak it to your quirks—head to Preferences on the

main page. If you want your browser to remember your preferences, you need to set it to accept cookies—Tools > Internet Options > Privacy for IE.

Language, please

You can choose to restrict searches to only English pages, but remember Google also provides a reasonably accurate translation of pages in five listed languages—German, French, Spanish, Italian and Portuguese. Also, you may occasionally need results that are listed in another language—say, if you're researching French poetry. If you only need English results, set it from the Advanced Search page instead.

Numbers and pages

You can set the number of returned results on a single page, and the way in which

Google Keywords		
Keyword/ symbol	Usage	Action
[+]	Chevrolet +Camaro	Looks for documents containing both 'Chevrolet' and 'Camaro'
[-]	Chevrolet -Camaro	Results will contain 'Chevrolet' but not 'Camaro'
[~]	~transducer	Searches for the term 'transducer' as well as its synonyms
OR	May OR June	Results will have either 'May' or 'June', or both
Cache:	cache:http://www.yoursite.com/	Returns Google's cached pages of www.yoursite.com
define:	define:virus	Gives the definition of the word 'virus'
site:	Apple site:www.food.com	Will restrict search to pages containing 'apple' only at www.food.com
related:	related:www.greatvacations.com	Will fetch results of sites similar to www.greatvacations.com
info:	info:www.sweepstakes.com	Will present information that Google has on www.sweepstakes.com

For more search terms check out <http://www.google.com/help/operators.html>

Tips & Tricks, Software shortcuts, Q&A know-how, How to guides, Step-by-step tutorials, Beginner guides

Help

www.zdnetindia.com/help